desired, by giving the government a notice of not less than three months in writing.

The Minister told Talwar one final time that if he did not resign, he would be dismissed. Talwar remained defiant. Finally, on August 4, 1976, (coincidentally Vaghul's birthday), Talwar was given thirteen months leave, (even though he had not applied for any), and asked to hand over charge to the Managing Director of the bank. Vaghul says that even after arming itself with the required powers, the government could not bring itself to sack Talwar. So great was the atmosphere of fear at the time that no one from the SBI came to see Talwar off that evening.

Vaghul, when he came to know that Talwar had reached his residence, went to meet him. He found him smiling and cheerful. Talwar with his deep faith in the divine had accepted his unceremonious departure from the bank as a part of the unfolding of the divine will. He told Vaghul, 'Where is the question of accepting or not accepting? You have to learn to enjoy all the time the Divine play. The work in the bank is over. What the Divine has in store for me I do not know. Whatever it is, I will serve the Divine with devotion and always enjoy being His instrument.'[46]

Talwar then spoke to Nani Palkhivala and asked his advice. He wanted to challenge the government order since he had at no point asked for leave.[47] Palkhivala advised caution; he told Talwar to let the matter rest. Talwar accepted the advice with reluctance, but wrote to Indira Gandhi apprising her of the facts of the case and seeking an interview. The letter was ignored. Talwar's successor was his own batchmate, T.R. Varadachary, who was the Managing Director. Kakodkar says that the Central Board of the bank sanctioned the loan after Varadachary became the Chairman.[48]

Talwar retired to the Auroville Ashram at Pondicherry with his wife Shakti, where his mode of transport was the humble bicycle. When the Janata government came to power in 1977, attempts were made to secure a suitable position for Talwar, but these were all vetoed by Morarji. Finally H.T. Parekh, who was the Chairman of ICICI, consulted Finance Minister H.M. Patel, and it was decided to appoint Talwar as the nominee Chairman of a sick company, National Rayons. Talwar was in Pondicherry at the time and wrote to the Finance Minister requesting an interview with the Prime Minister since the latter seemed to have misgivings about him.